

## Japan Machinery: Automation: Trade statistics: April 2026 robot/Robodrill volume inferred from customs data

The Ministry of Finance announced April 2026 trade statistics (customs data) during morning trading on May 28. We use this data as an indicator of volume trends for Fanuc's (Sell) robots and Robodrill No. 30 vertical machining centers, and Yaskawa Electric's (Buy, on the CL) robots. Japanese companies have a large share of the global robot market and high domestic production ratios. Since Japan accounts for the majority of global robot production, we believe export volume trends from Japan to the rest of the world can be viewed as an indicator of investment in robots and automation, mainly in the auto and electronics industries. In this note, we outline our views on the robot industry and casing demand trends inferred from this month's data.

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**Exhibit 1: Robots: Trade statistics summary**

| Robot: Japan       |              |              |               |               |
|--------------------|--------------|--------------|---------------|---------------|
|                    | N. America   | Europe       | China         | Global        |
| <b>Volume</b>      | <b>2,065</b> | <b>1,991</b> | <b>6,206</b>  | <b>14,271</b> |
| yoy                | -4%          | 74%          | 33%           | 41%           |
| mom                | -19%         | 13%          | -18%          | -4%           |
| <b>Value (¥mn)</b> | <b>5,569</b> | <b>5,187</b> | <b>10,899</b> | <b>27,532</b> |
| yoy                | -9%          | 87%          | 41%           | 33%           |
| mom                | -22%         | 7%           | -18%          | -7%           |
| <b>ASP (¥mn)</b>   | <b>2.70</b>  | <b>2.61</b>  | <b>1.76</b>   | <b>1.93</b>   |
| yoy                | -5%          | 7%           | 6%            | -6%           |
| mom                | -4%          | -5%          | 0%            | -4%           |

| Robot: Fanuc (GSE) |              |              |              |               |
|--------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|---------------|
|                    | N. America   | Europe       | China        | Global        |
| <b>Volume</b>      | <b>1,633</b> | <b>1,578</b> | <b>4,665</b> | <b>9,398</b>  |
| yoy                | -1%          | 142%         | 38%          | 49%           |
| mom                | -23%         | 18%          | -14%         | -4%           |
| <b>Value (¥mn)</b> | <b>4,834</b> | <b>4,532</b> | <b>9,245</b> | <b>20,536</b> |
| yoy                | -8%          | 130%         | 40%          | 35%           |
| mom                | -23%         | 15%          | -14%         | -8%           |
| <b>ASP (¥mn)</b>   | <b>2.96</b>  | <b>2.87</b>  | <b>1.98</b>  | <b>2.19</b>   |
| yoy                | -7%          | -5%          | 1%           | -9%           |
| mom                | -1%          | -2%          | 0%           | -4%           |

Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 2: Robodrills: Trade statistics summary**

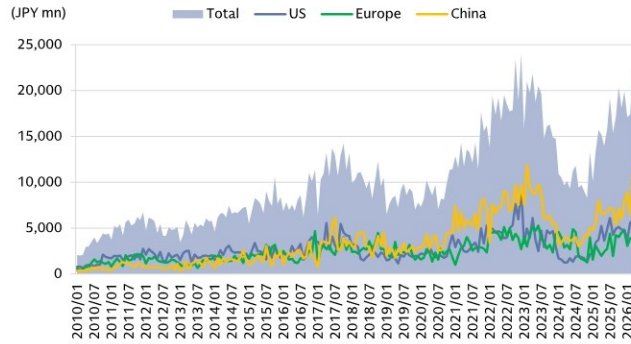
| Robodrill: Japan   |               |              |              |               |
|--------------------|---------------|--------------|--------------|---------------|
|                    | Asia          | China        | AeCJ         | Global        |
| <b>Volume</b>      | <b>1,571</b>  | <b>837</b>   | <b>734</b>   | <b>1,642</b>  |
| yoy                | -25%          | -27%         | -22%         | -24%          |
| mom                | 12%           | -6%          | 43%          | 8%            |
| <b>Value (¥mn)</b> | <b>10,925</b> | <b>5,991</b> | <b>4,934</b> | <b>12,621</b> |
| yoy                | -8%           | -1%          | -15%         | -5%           |
| mom                | 0%            | -6%          | 7%           | -5%           |
| <b>ASP (¥mn)</b>   | <b>6.95</b>   | <b>7.16</b>  | <b>6.72</b>  | <b>7.69</b>   |
| yoy                | 23%           | 36%          | 9%           | 24%           |
| mom                | -11%          | 1%           | -25%         | -12%          |

| Robodrill: Fanuc (GSE) |              |              |              |              |
|------------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|
|                        | Asia         | China        | AeCJ         | Global       |
| <b>Volume</b>          | <b>1,147</b> | <b>621</b>   | <b>526</b>   | <b>1,149</b> |
| yoy                    | -24%         | -16%         | -31%         | -24%         |
| mom                    | 5%           | -11%         | 34%          | 4%           |
| <b>Value (¥mn)</b>     | <b>6,789</b> | <b>3,869</b> | <b>2,920</b> | <b>6,842</b> |
| yoy                    | -17%         | -3%          | -30%         | -18%         |
| mom                    | -7%          | -12%         | 1%           | -9%          |
| <b>ASP (¥mn)</b>       | <b>5.92</b>  | <b>6.23</b>  | <b>5.55</b>  | <b>5.95</b>  |
| yoy                    | 9%           | 16%          | 1%           | 8%           |
| mom                    | -11%         | -1%          | -24%         | -12%         |

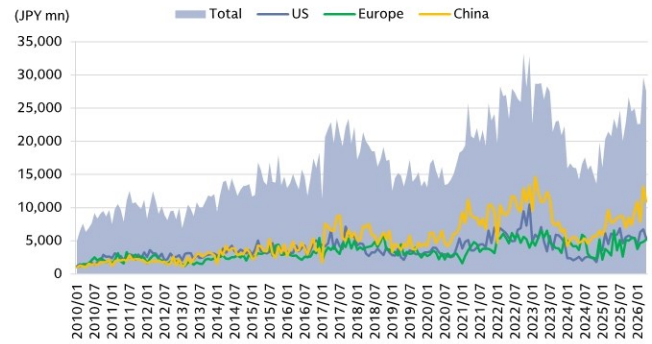
Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Robot export volume (Fanuc, Yaskawa Electric, and Japan overall)**

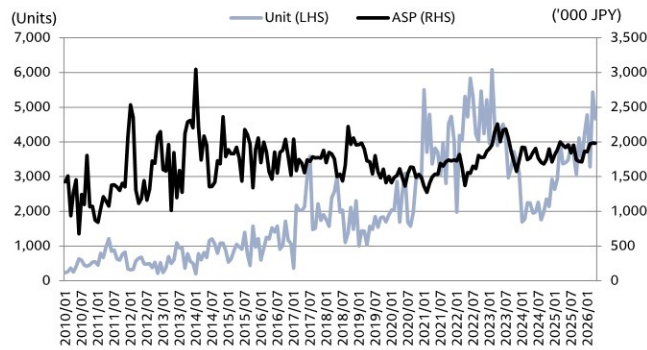
- **Fanuc:** We estimate that Fanuc robots made at its Yamanashi main plant and its Tsukuba plant account for the bulk of exports from Tokyo/Yokohama. We believe the mom decline in export volume is attributable to the unwinding of the fiscal year-end effect. We think mom momentum of -14% in export volume to China suggests that Fanuc is not seeing the same sustained growth as some machine tools and FA equipment. We assume that companies with a strong presence in smaller 6-axis or SCARA robots are better positioned to benefit from AI-related demand in China. Although there are differences in the prior-year comparison base, yoy momentum for North America has also turned negative, and we will need to watch for whether the environment here is also changing.
- **Yaskawa Electric (global exports from Moji in April: 1,309 units, +35% yoy/+33% mom):** Yaskawa Electric is the only major robot maker with a production base in Kyushu, and we therefore believe its robots account for the majority of export volume from the port of Moji. Exports were flat to down for South Korea (372 units; 0% mom) and China (104 units; -21% mom). At the same time, the trend in exports to India (381 units) improved, rising +140% mom. Given the characteristics of the company's regional exports, we believe the increase was mainly driven by automotive-related projects, and reflects project circumstances specific to India rather than a global trend.

**Exhibit 3: Fanuc: Robot shipment value by destination (GSe)**

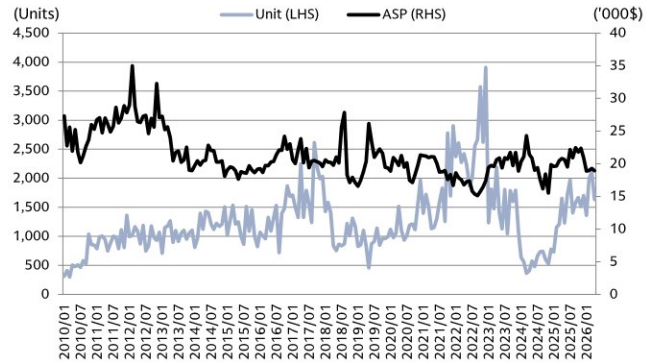
Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 4: Japan: Robot shipment value by destination**

Source: Ministry of Finance, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 5: Fanuc: Robot export volume to China and average export price (GSe)**

Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 6: Fanuc: Robot export volume to North America and average export price (GSe)**

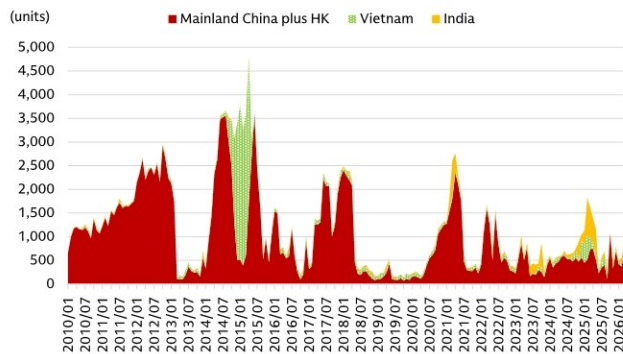
Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research



### Vertical machining center export volume from Tokyo/Yokohama (assumes Fanuc accounts for the majority of export volume)

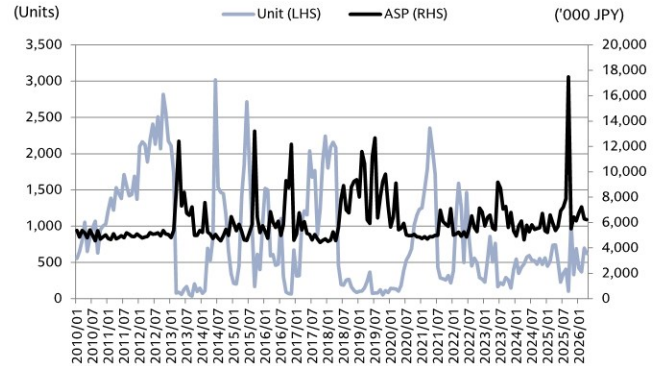
- **Fanuc:** We estimate that Robodrills made at Fanuc's Tsukuba plant account for the bulk of the No. 30 vertical machining centers exported to Asia from Tokyo/Yokohama customs. Mom momentum in export volume to China was down -11%, and we believe this is due to a roll over from peak post-Lunar New Year demand from major customers, such as leading US smartphone makers. Moreover, the peak season ended early, with exports down -16% yoy. We assume momentum in the current cycle may have been limited due to factors such as persistently high labor costs. While momentum in export volume to India grew a sharp +328% mom, the volume figure is low compared with past levels. Volume still looks too small to suggest that demand from US smartphone makers has completely shifted to India, but this warrants continued monitoring. We think that smartphone-related demand could remain limited in CY26 although this needs further monitoring.

**Exhibit 7: Fanuc: Breakdown of Robodrill export volume by region (GSe)**



Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 8: Fanuc: Robodrill export volume to China and average export price (GSe)**



Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

### Price Target Risks and Methodology - Yaskawa Electric (6506.T)

Our 12-month target price of ¥9,200 is based on FY2/28E EV/EBITDA, applying the sector-average multiple of 10X and a 90% sector-relative premium.

Key downside risks include (1) a slowdown in semiconductor and AI Capex related business, (2) slower-than-expected results from cost optimization measures, and (3) disappointment in the capital policy and growth strategy in the next medium-term plan and long-term vision.

### Price Target Risks and Methodology - Fanuc (6954.T)

Our 12-month target price of ¥5,600 is based on FY3/28E EV/EBITDA, applying the sector-average multiple of 10X and a 70% sector-relative premium.

Key upside risks include sales in the FA business recovering to levels above past peaks, greater-than-expected improvement in robot business margins, and share buybacks or other moves to strengthen shareholder returns.

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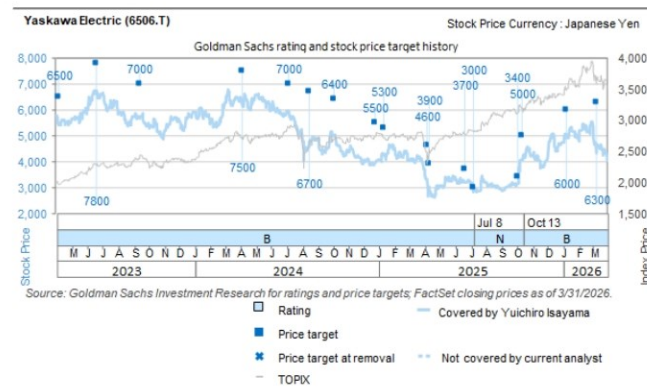
Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

|        | Rating Distribution |      |      |  | Investment Banking Relationships |      |      |
|--------|---------------------|------|------|--|----------------------------------|------|------|
|        | Buy                 | Hold | Sell |  | Buy                              | Hold | Sell |
| Global | 50%                 | 34%  | 16%  |  | 65%                              | 60%  | 45%  |

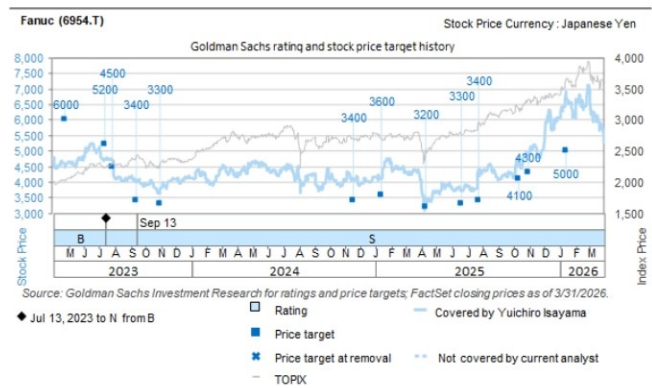
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## Target price history table(s)

### Fanuc (6954.T)

| Date of report | Target price (¥) | Closing price (¥) |
|----------------|------------------|-------------------|
| 28-May-26      | 5,600            | 7,984             |
| 26-Apr-26      | 5,300            | 6,256             |
| 14-Jan-26      | 5,000            | 6,935             |
| 31-Oct-25      | 4,300            | 4,909             |
| 13-Oct-25      | 4,100            | 4,780             |
| 25-Jul-25      | 3,400            | 4,220             |
| 20-Jun-25      | 3,300            | 3,713             |
| 11-Apr-25      | 3,200            | 3,388             |
| 12-Jan-25      | 3,600            | 4,116             |
| 19-Nov-24      | 3,400            | 4,099             |
| 31-Oct-23      | 3,300            | 3,653             |
| 13-Sep-23      | 3,400            | 4,081             |
| 28-Jul-23      | 4,500            | 4,689             |
| 13-Jul-23      | 5,200            | 4,762             |

### Yaskawa Electric (6506.T)

| Date of report | Target price (¥) | Closing price (¥) |
|----------------|------------------|-------------------|
| 28-May-26      | 9,200            | 7,136             |
| 29-Apr-26      | 7,300            | 5,381             |
| 10-Apr-26      | 6,500            | 4,894             |
| 09-Mar-26      | 6,300            | 4,325             |
| 09-Jan-26      | 6,000            | 5,026             |
| 13-Oct-25      | 5,000            | 4,085             |
| 03-Oct-25      | 3,400            | 3,178             |
| 08-Jul-25      | 3,000            | 2,833             |
| 20-Jun-25      | 3,700            | 3,190             |
| 11-Apr-25      | 3,900            | 2,881             |
| 06-Apr-25      | 4,600            | 3,344             |
| 10-Jan-25      | 5,300            | 4,271             |
| 24-Dec-24      | 5,500            | 3,950             |
| 04-Oct-24      | 6,400            | 5,023             |
| 16-Aug-24      | 6,700            | 4,796             |
| 05-Jul-24      | 7,000            | 5,972             |
| 05-Apr-24      | 7,500            | 6,174             |
| 13-Sep-23      | 7,000            | 5,725             |
| 20-Jun-23      | 7,800            | 6,635             |

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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